MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | DevOps & Platform Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including 2+ years focused on CI/CD pipelines, test infrastructure, and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and merge-request ephemeral environments for three product teams. Experienced with Docker, Helm, Kubernetes namespace-level environments, and infrastructure automation; also maintains a personal k3s homelab using GitOps and Terraform. Brings a strong analytical approach, clear technical documentation, and experience supporting collaboration across engineering, QA, and product teams. Moving toward a full-time DevOps / platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and build: GitLab CI, Jenkins, pipeline optimization, artifact publishing, dependency caching

Containers and orchestration: Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s

Infrastructure as code and automation: Terraform (personal projects), Ansible (basic), Bash, Python

Monitoring and observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, test metrics dashboards

Cloud and hosting: Hetzner VPS; AWS learning projects (EC2 and S3 basics)

Testing and quality: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Data and systems: PostgreSQL, SQL, Linux, Git

Other: Argo CD, GitLab API, Java (test code)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration, and end-to-end test stages, plus artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling workflows, parallelizing test jobs, caching dependencies, and separating end-to-end testing into its own stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments for applications, PostgreSQL, and seeded data, deployed with Helm to the company's shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 2%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and built a flaky-test dashboard using PostgreSQL, Grafana, and the GitLab API.
- Wrote the internal "how our CI works" documentation used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana, and Loki for monitoring; configured Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Implemented short-lived environments for merge requests, including the application, PostgreSQL, and seeded data, deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against the environments.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled CI pipelines across three teams, parallelized test jobs, introduced dependency caching, and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team.
- Helped teams identify and address frequent failures; the flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 2%.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation | Exam scheduled for January 2027

Terraform Associate practice tests completed; exam not taken

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)